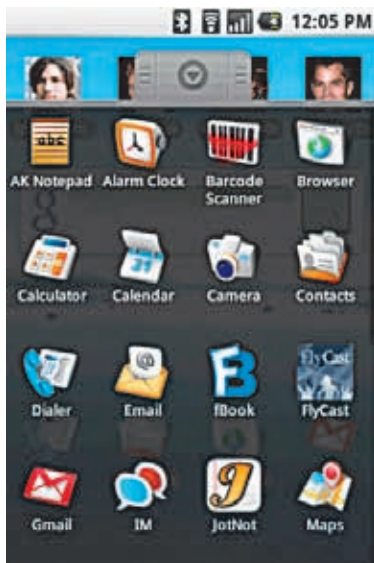


at the top of the screen. You can then pull it down to show alerts such as new messages or missed calls.

Browser

The Android web browser 'Chrome-Light' takes its roots from the open source Webkit engine much like its bigger brother - Google Chrome, an instant hit among the masses. Interestingly, Apple's Safari browser is also based on the same platform. Chrome-Light is capable of handling any type of web content (including Flash) that a desktop computer's web browser can handle. This design opens up a treasure trove of possible browser-based services already available to PC users, including contact management, document creation, GPS direction services, and VoIP (Voice over Internet Protocol) services.



Default Homescreen of iPhone 3GS running OS 3.0

Browsing experience on TI's G1 (or HTC Dream) is as good as it can get. The browser interface is slick, the text is rendered beautifully and the rendering is much faster than compared to its native counterparts I.E. and S60 browser. Aside from the lack of multi-touch controls for zooming, the browsing experience on different Android devices is comparable to that on the iPhone. Android has native support for multi-touch, but the feature is disabled at the kernel level (possibly to avoid infringing Apple patents on touch-screen technology). Many unofficial mods have been developed that enables multi-touch, but requires superuser access to the device to flash an unsigned kernel.

Market

Just such as App Store on the iPhone OS, Android's Market is an online catalogue of applications that lets people find, buy, download, and rate applications and other content for mobile phones equipped with the Android OS. This online market gives flexibility to the developer to keep tabs on his applications, review his products ratings, view information about the downloads and comments and manage and publish different applications versions. For the user, they can review and download applications. The best